



Event Planning Resource Guide

A Practical Guide to Planning, Promoting, and Operating Events at SOU

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Publication Information

This guide consolidates research, recommendations, and operational information developed in the Spring 2026 section of BA 410/510 - *Event Management*. It is intended as a practical starting point for students, faculty, staff, departments, and approved external organizers planning events at Southern Oregon University (SOU).

CURRENT INFORMATION: Policies, forms, contacts, venue details, and service requirements may change. Use the directly linked University resources throughout this guide to confirm current requirements before making commitments.

How to Use This Guide

- Begin with the Quick-Start Planning Roadmap and Chapter 2 to establish the event timeline.
- Use Chapter 4 to identify approvals before committing money, signing agreements, or announcing the event.
- Use Chapter 5 to compare venues, then confirm all details directly with the responsible venue.
- Use the chapter checklists and editable appendices to assign responsibilities and document decisions.
- Use the direct links provided in this guide and its appendices to contact offices, submit forms, and review additional resources.

Information Labels

Label	Meaning
REQUIRED	A current University, venue, contractual, or regulatory requirement.
RECOMMENDED	A planning practice that improves readiness, access, or attendee experience.
CONFIRM WITH VENUE	A condition that varies by room, event type, staffing, or schedule.
CURRENT RESOURCE	A directly linked official source that should be reviewed for current information.

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1: Event Planning at Southern Oregon University

1.1 Purpose of Event Planning

Event planning is a coordination process in which the organizer ensures that all parts of the event work together. Successful planning begins with the event's purpose and continues through post-event evaluation. The organizer should be able to explain what will happen, who is responsible, what resources are required, what approvals apply, and how problems will be managed.

1.2 Intended Users

- Registered student organizations
- Academic programs and University departments
- Faculty and staff event organizers
- Athletics and recreation planners
- Conference and performance organizers
- Approved external users of University facilities

1.3 Common Event Types

Event type	Typical planning needs
Meeting or workshop	Room, technology, accessibility, registration, modest setup
Lecture or guest speaker	Approval, contract, travel, presentation technology, security review
Performance	Venue production, staffing, ticketing, rights, rehearsal, load-in
Conference	Multiple rooms, registration, catering, vendors, wayfinding, parking
Reception or banquet	Catering, alcohol, seating, service flow, cleanup
Athletic or recreation event	Facility approval, participant risk, staffing, medical and crowd plans
Outdoor event	Weather, power, temporary structures, restrooms, grounds protection
Hybrid event	Internet, sound, remote moderation, captions, recording permissions

1.4 Planning Responsibilities

Role	Primary responsibility
Sponsoring organization	Purpose, budget, approvals, contracting route, attendee communication
Event manager	Integrated schedule, decisions, staff coordination, closeout
Venue representative	Room access, house rules, building systems, required staffing
Service provider or vendor	Contracted scope, arrival, setup, operation, removal
University office	Approval or review within its area of responsibility
Event staff and volunteers	Assigned tasks within the event command structure

1.5 Core Planning Questions

Area	Question
Authorization	Has the event been submitted and approved through the appropriate process?
Audience	Who will attend, and are there minors, visitors, volunteers, or accommodation requests?
Budget	What funding is available, and which expenses are required?
Venue	Does the space support capacity, layout, accessibility, parking, load-in, and program needs?
Technology	What equipment is included, what must be requested, and who may operate it?
Risk	What could cause harm or disrupt the event, and what controls are required?
Operations	Who is responsible for setup, decisions, emergency response, and teardown?
Evaluation	How will the organizer determine whether the event met its goals?

1.6 Requirement Categories

- University requirements apply across the institution or to a defined class of events.
- Venue requirements apply to the specific building, room, field, or operational unit.
- Vendor requirements arise from contracts, insurance, staffing, or service procedures.
- Regulatory requirements arise from local, state, or federal law.
- Recommendations are planning practices rather than minimum compliance thresholds.

1.7 Quick-Start Planning Roadmap

Step	Action	Primary Questions
1	Define the event	Purpose, audience, format, attendance, outcomes
2	Identify sponsorship	Student organization, department, program, or external client
3	Establish budget	Funding, required expenses, contingency
4	Begin approvals	Hawk N.E.S.T., venue, food, alcohol, vendors, travel, risk
5	Select venue	Capacity, layout, accessibility, technology, staffing, parking
6	Arrange services	Catering, vendors, rentals, security, production, printing
7	Plan operations	Staffing, run of show, emergency planning, guest flow
8	Promote the event	Listings, digital channels, print, arrival information
9	Confirm and test	Final count, technical walkthrough, staff briefing
10	Execute and evaluate	Operate, close out, reconcile, debrief

RECOMMENDED: Assign one event manager with authority to coordinate approvals, vendors, the venue, and event-day decisions.

2: Event Planning Roadmap

2.1 The Event Lifecycle

Define purpose and outcomes

Identify the audience, format, attendance estimate, date flexibility, and measures of success.

Identify sponsorship and authority

Determine whether the sponsor is a registered student organization, University unit, academic program, or external organizer.

Establish a preliminary budget

Identify funding, required costs, optional enhancements, and contingency.

Begin the approval process

Submit the event and identify additional reviews involving food, alcohol, travel, vendors, contracts, risk, minors, or public attendance.

Select and reserve the venue

Evaluate capacity, layout, accessibility, technology, staffing, load-in, schedule conflicts, and parking.

Arrange services

Coordinate catering, vendors, rentals, security, production, printing, and transportation.

Plan operations

Develop the run-of-show, staffing plan, command structure, accessibility plan, and emergency plan.

Promote the event

Select appropriate channels, create accessible materials, and communicate arrival and accommodation information.

Confirm and test

Complete the final walkthrough, technical test, vendor confirmation, and staff briefing.

Execute and evaluate

Operate the event, complete load-out and financial closeout, and document lessons learned.

2.2 Recommended Planning Windows

Event profile	Recommended planning start	Common dependencies
Small, routine event with limited services	At least one month before the event	Room, approval, basic technology, promotion
Catered, vendor-supported, or setup-intensive event	Six to eight weeks before the event	Catering, waivers, contracts, rentals, staffing
Large, public, complex, performance, or production-heavy event	Three to four months before the event	Venue calendar, production, security, vendors, marketing
Travel event	At least two months before travel	Travel approval, risk, transportation, lodging, funding
Highly scheduled performance venue	As early as the venue recommends	Academic calendar, rehearsals, production, ticketing

RECOMMENDED: These windows are planning targets, not substitutes for current University, venue, vendor, or regulatory deadlines.

2.3 Critical Path

The critical path is the sequence of tasks that controls whether the event can proceed. A venue cannot be finalized until the event format is known; a vendor cannot be confirmed until contracting and insurance requirements are understood; marketing should not promise capacity, parking, food, or access before those items are confirmed.

- Identify approval gates that prevent later work from proceeding.
- Set internal deadlines earlier than external deadlines.
- Assign an owner to every task.
- Record dependencies and consequences of delay.
- Update the path when the venue, attendance, or event format changes.

3: Budgeting and Financial Planning

3.1 Build the Budget in Stages

Budget stage	Purpose
Preliminary	Tests whether the concept is financially possible.
Working	Tracks quotes, approvals, deposits, and anticipated revenue.
Final pre-event	Reflects confirmed attendance, vendors, staffing, and contingency.
Actual	Records final income and expenses for reconciliation and evaluation.

3.2 Revenue and Funding Sources

- Student organization or department funds
- Sponsorship and gifts approved through the appropriate University process
- Registration or ticket revenue
- Fundraising
- Donations or gifts in kind
- External client or partner support
- See Appendix C for additional Policy and Form Documents

3.3 Expense Categories

Category	Possible expenses
Venue	Reservation, required staffing, custodial support, security, after-hours access
Food and beverage	Catering, service staff, equipment, linens, alcohol controls
Production	Sound, lighting, projection, recording, internet, operators
Rentals	Furniture, staging, tents, registration equipment, décor
Marketing	Design, printing, digital promotion, signage
Accessibility	Interpreters, CART, captioning, accessible materials, additional setup
Transportation and parking	Guest parking, loading, travel, shuttles
Risk and compliance	Insurance, permits, security, safety equipment
Contingency	Weather, substitutions, attendance changes, equipment failure

3.4 Required, Conditional, and Optional Costs

Classify expenses before reducing the budget. A required technician, accessible route, insurance review, or security assignment is not an optional enhancement. Décor, upgraded menus, recording packages, or additional entertainment may be optional unless they are central to the event's stated purpose.

3.5 Quotes and Current Rates

To maintain the accuracy and long-term usefulness of this guide, specific charges for spaces, goods, and services are intentionally omitted. Rates, fees, staffing costs, and service charges may change based on the event, venue, provider, schedule, and scope of work. Planners are expected to exercise due diligence by requesting current written quotes and confirming all applicable costs before making commitments or finalizing the event budget.

- Ask whether labor, delivery, setup, pickup, taxes, or after-hours charges are included.
- Confirm cancellation and change deadlines.
- Record quote expiration dates.
- Include costs for required operators or venue personnel.
- Maintain contingency for scope changes.

3.6 Student Organization Financial Controls

Registered student organizations must use University-approved financial accounts, purchasing methods, and fundraising tools. Cash, card activity, reimbursements, deposits, and attendance documentation must follow the current process assigned to the sponsoring organization and funding source.

Review current club finance and event guidance through the [SOU Clubs and Organizations webpage](#).

3.7 Cash Handling

- Arrange cash-box checkout and return before sales begin.
- Identify approved secure storage for multi-day activity.
- Assign two people to reconcile cash when possible.
- Deposit funds through the required University process.
- Do not allow organizational cash to remain in an individual's possession.
- See Appendix C for additional Policy and Form Documents

3.8 Fundraising

Raffles, public solicitation, business solicitation, crowdfunding, charitable fundraising, and gifts in kind require advance review. Current University policy requires consultation for certain raffles, letter-writing campaigns, or solicitations totaling \$1,000 or more during a year. See [Gifts-In-Kind documentation](#) form if required.

3.9 Budget Template

Line item	Estimated	Quoted	Approved	Actual	Notes
Venue / Staffing					
Food / Beverage					
Technology / Production					
Vendors / Rentals					
Marketing / Printing					
Accessibility					
Parking / Transportation					
Insurance / Permits					
Contingency					

4: Booking, Authorization, and Approval

4.1 Venue Coordination Is Decentralized

SOU does not maintain one centralized events office for all campus spaces. Each building, venue, or operational unit manages its own availability, house rules, staffing, and reservation process. Use the applicable venue profile and linked booking resource.

4.2 Student Organization Events

The Office of Student Belonging and Engagement, within SOU Student Life, supports student clubs and organizations and administers their event-approval processes. The office is located in Stevenson Union, Room 312, and current club questions are routed through the Clubs and Organizations Coordinator.

Access current guidance through the [SOU Clubs and Organizations webpage](#), and use [Hawk N.E.S.T.](#) for the student-organization and event-management functions currently supported by the platform.

4.3 Submit Early

Required timelines vary according to the venue, sponsoring unit, attendance, travel, food, alcohol, vendors, risk, and production needs. Begin early enough to complete approvals without relying on minimum submission windows.

4.4 Reservation and Approval Are Separate

- An approved event is not guaranteed a venue.
- A room reservation does not confirm that all activities are approved.
- Venue approval does not authorize a contract or purchase.
- Vendor setup does not authorize the vendor to perform the service.
- Marketing should not begin until essential event facts are reliable.

4.5 Contracting Authority

Students and other unauthorized individuals may not sign contracts or enter binding agreements on behalf of the University. Route proposed agreements, purchases, and vendor arrangements through the current contracting and purchasing process before making a commitment.

Contact [SOU Purchasing and Contracting](#) and use the [SOU Service Center forms page](#) for current documents and instructions.

4.6 Common Approval Matrix

Event feature	Possible review	Planning action
Food or catering	Catering, venue, outside-food approval	Confirm service and approval before purchase
Alcohol	University, venue, state, insurance, security	Complete all required approvals before service
Outside vendor	Venue, contracting, insurance, payment setup	Do not confirm vendor prematurely
Travel	Student Life or sponsoring unit, risk, transportation	Begin at least two months early
Minors	Risk, supervision, participant documentation	Confirm current youth requirements
Volunteers	Volunteer documentation, supervision, insurance	Define roles before service
Public film	Copyright or public-performance rights	Obtain rights before promotion
Political event	Venue and University policy	Maintain viewpoint-neutral procedures
Fundraising	Student organization finance and development review	Confirm methods and thresholds
High-risk activity	Risk assessment, Public Safety, insurance	Document controls and responsible roles

5: Venue Selection and Campus Event Spaces

5.1 Selecting the Right Venue

Factor	What to confirm
Capacity	Approved capacity for the intended setup
Layout	Fixed, flexible, divisible, or venue-approved configuration
Accessibility	Complete route, seating, restrooms, communication access, emergency egress
Included equipment	Installed or ordinarily included systems and furniture
Available by request	University-owned equipment requiring separate scheduling or approval
Staffing	Building, technical, custodial, security, production, or organizer-provided roles
Food and beverage	Catering rules, alcohol permission, service locations
Load-in	Vehicle access, entrances, elevators, storage, access window
Parking	Guest, accessible, vendor, and loading arrangements
Schedule	Classes, practices, rehearsals, performances, and other events

5.2 Building Operations Contacts

When inquiring about a venue, contact the appropriate [building manager](#) for more information.

5.3 Stevenson Union

Stevenson Union is the primary student-union environment and includes meeting, conference, social, performance, banquet, and tabling spaces. Room capabilities vary considerably. Use the official inventory as a starting point and confirm current details with scheduling.

To reserve a space or confirm setup, staffing, included equipment, and equipment available by request, [contact Stevenson Union Scheduling](#) and review the [Stevenson Union event-space page](#).

Space	Recommended uses	Planning notes
SU Gallery — SU 323	Meetings, exhibits, receptions, presentations	Confirm current seating configurations and presentation capability
Guanajuato Room — SU 315	Meals, meetings, workshops, receptions	Fixed or limited layout; confirm dividers and display systems
Dankook Room — SU 314	Meetings, conference breakouts	Dividable room; confirm equipment separately
Senate Chambers — SU 313	Formal meetings, workshops, presentations	Hollow-square orientation; confirm audience capacity
Meeting Room — SU 318	Small meetings and conferences	Conference-style room with presentation capability
Classroom — SU 319	Lectures, workshops, training	Confirm furniture flexibility and current equipment
Rogue River Room	Conferences, lectures, banquets, dances	Large flexible room; staffing and production may be required
ASSOU Lounge	Informal meetings, dinners, lectures	Social setting with limited production capability
SU Arena	Exhibits, lectures, dances, banquets	Large open room; confirm stage, sound, and layout
Diversions	Concerts, dances, social events, exhibits	House systems and concessions may be available
Courtyard	Tabling, fairs, informal outdoor activity	Weather and exterior-use requirements apply

5.3.1 Stevenson Union Planning Notes

- Confirm room-reset and custodial expectations.
- Weekend and after-hours events may require additional coordination.
- Do not design the program around legacy equipment without confirmation.
- Building-specific approval is required before posting publicity.
- Reserve enough setup time for testing and corrections before guests arrive.

5.4 Oregon Center for the Arts at SOU

The Oregon Center for the Arts at Southern Oregon University (OCA) is the administrative arts umbrella for academic arts programs and affiliated performance and exhibition activities. Its buildings, venues, galleries, production functions, and ticketing services are related but not interchangeable.

For general routing, [contact the Oregon Center for the Arts](#). For ticketing and patron services, [contact the OCA Box Office](#).

5.4.1 OCA Administration and Ticketing

- General OCA administration is separate from venue production and booking.
- The OCA Box Office supports ticketing and patron services for applicable performances.
- Confirm venue-specific production, staffing, and rental needs through the applicable facility.

5.4.2 Music Building

The Music Building is home to the University's Music Department and the SOU Music Recital Hall.

5.4.2.1 SOU Music Recital Hall

The SOU Music Recital Hall is the University's primary musical performance venue and seats up to 436 patrons. The hall supports concerts, recitals, ceremonies, lectures, recording, and livestreaming. Production access, instruments, furniture, and staffing are assigned according to the event.

- Begin major or date-sensitive inquiries as early as possible, potentially a year or more in advance.
- Confirm installed sound, presentation, recording, livestreaming, and stage-lighting capabilities.
- Contact the venue for equipment details specific to the event rather than relying on published quantities.
- Coordinate rehearsals, load-in, green-room needs, recording, box office, and house management.
- Food and drink restrictions apply in performance spaces.

5.4.2.2 Music Building Support Spaces

Lobby, reception, classroom, practice, and green-room uses are subject to academic schedules and venue approval.

5.4.3 Theatre Building

5.4.3.1 SOU Main Stage Theatre

The Main Stage Theatre seats 302 and supports theatrical productions, presentations, screenings, concerts, and other performance-centered events. Production staffing, rehearsal, ticketing, load-in, and technical requirements must be confirmed with the venue.

5.4.3.2 SOU Black Box Theatre

The Black Box Theatre accommodates up to 90 people in configurations approved for the production. Because the room is flexible, seating capacity, stage footprint, accessible seating, and emergency routes depend on the approved layout.

5.4.3.3 Additional Theatre Spaces

Movement, acting, performance, rehearsal, and instructional studios may be available for suitable uses. Confirm eligibility, room restrictions, food and beverage rules, floor protection, staffing, and maximum reservation duration.

5.4.4 Visual Arts Facilities

5.4.4.1 Art Building

The Art Building houses academic art facilities, Center for Visual Arts gallery spaces, and Meese Auditorium. The building is adjacent to the Schneider Museum of Art but is managed separately.

5.4.4.2 Meese Auditorium — Art Building

Meese Auditorium is a lecture and presentation venue inside the Art Building. Always identify the full venue and building to distinguish it from the Meese Room in Hannon Library.

5.4.4.3 Schneider Museum of Art

The Schneider Museum of Art is a separate museum facility suited to exhibitions, receptions, cultural programs, and interdisciplinary events. Museum operations, installation limits, catering, and reservations must be confirmed directly with the museum.

5.4.4.4 Marion Ady Building and Center for Visual Arts

The Marion Ady Building contains additional Center for Visual Arts galleries. The Center for Visual Arts is a gallery program spanning multiple facilities and should not be used interchangeably with the Art Building, Marion Ady Building, museum, or OCA.

5.5 Hannon Library

To reserve a space or confirm setup, staffing, included equipment, and equipment available by request, [contact the Hannon Library scheduler](#) with booking questions.

Space	Primary use	Planning note
Meese Room — LIB 305	Meetings, lectures, events	Published capacity 102; confirm current equipment and policy
Gutenberg Room	Meetings and presentations	Confirm capacity, layout, and display systems
Whiteboard Room	Collaborative meetings	Confirm furniture and technology
Higgs Seminar Room	Seminars and small meetings	Confirm access and setup
Other reservable rooms	Instruction, meetings, study-related events	Use current library reservation information

5.6 Academic Classrooms and Buildings

Academic classrooms may be available for approved conference or event use. Rooms may be provided in their existing configuration, and furniture rearrangement or technical support may not be included.

Review the [SOU Conferences classroom-reservation page](#) for the current process.

- Confirm whether the room is available to the sponsoring organization.
- Confirm included equipment and operator access.
- Do not assume furniture may be moved.
- Account for class schedules and building hours.
- Confirm opening, closing, cleanup, and after-hours procedures.
- Classroom spaces are also available in the Computer Science Building, Britt Hall, and Taylor Hall. Contact the appropriate [building manager](#) for more information.

5.7 Lithia Motors Pavilion

5.7.1 Student Recreation Center

The Student Recreation Center is located within Lithia Motors Pavilion, but its reservable spaces are maintained and scheduled independently from University Athletics facilities.

Use the [Student Recreation Center facility-rentals page](#) to confirm gym, studio, climbing, activity, staffing, setup, and rate information.

5.7.2 University Athletics

University Athletics controls separate competition, spectator, production, and support spaces within Lithia Motors Pavilion. A Student Recreation Center reservation does not include Athletics-controlled areas. Confirm availability, approved use, staffing, equipment, production, and access with University Athletics.

5.8 Raider Athletics Complex

The Raider Athletics Complex includes Raider Stadium, Laurel Field, Raider Beach, Laurel Park, and related Athletics facilities. Capacity and availability depend on the approved event configuration, athletic schedules, field protection, temporary seating, production footprint, accessible seating, emergency access, and Athletics requirements.

5.8.1 Raider Stadium and Laurel Field

- Laurel Field is the playing field within Raider Stadium.
- Field use does not automatically include every stadium seating, concourse, production, or support area.
- Athletic competition, commencement, performance, and community-event layouts require separate capacity confirmation.
- Maintain emergency access and protect the field surface.
- Coordinate sound, power, lighting, security, box office, and vehicle load-in.

5.8.2 Raider Beach and Laurel Park

Confirm intended use, field or grounds conditions, utilities, restrooms, staffing, and Athletics approval.

5.9 Outdoor and Nontraditional Spaces

- Confirm grounds approval and venue ownership.
- Plan for weather, wildfire smoke, wind, heat, cold, and rain.
- Confirm power, temporary structures, restrooms, waste, and lighting.
- Maintain accessible routes and emergency access.
- Plan noise, neighborhood, class, and practice impacts.
- Protect landscaping, fields, pavement, and building surfaces.

Review the [SOU campus map](#) when planning guest arrival, accessible routes, entrances, loading, and wayfinding.

6: Food, Catering, Hospitality, and Alcohol Service

6.1 Contact Catering Early

Contact the University's contracted dining and [catering provider](#), as soon as the venue has been approved. Reach out early to secure your date on the service schedule, even if your menu, attendance, and event plans are still tentative.

NOTE: Request current menus, lead times, service options, staffing, equipment, and prices directly from the provider.

6.2 Catering Service Formats

Format	Best use	Operational considerations
Delivered catering	Meetings and simple receptions	Delivery point, setup, cleanup, temperature
Buffet	Meals and receptions	Queue, two-sided access, staffing, allergen labels
Boxed meals	Training, travel, timed programs	Dietary identification, distribution, waste
Beverage station	Meetings and social events	Power, water, cups, traffic, refills
Full service	Formal and large events	Staffing, service schedule, tables, linens, cleanup

6.3 Outside and Donated Food

Events seeking outside, donated, or otherwise noncontracted food service must complete the current approval process before purchasing or confirming food. Begin at least three weeks before the event whenever possible.

Use the [SOU Service Center forms page](#) to locate the current outside-food request and official submission deadline.

6.4 The Farm at SOU

The [Farm at SOU](#) is a student-centered educational farm supporting campus and community partnerships. [Contact The Farm](#) early to discuss seasonal produce, programming, tours, collaboration, timing, scope, and costs.

6.5 Dietary and Allergen Planning

- Collect dietary needs during registration when appropriate.
- Label ingredients and common allergens clearly.
- Provide vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, Halal, Kosher, or other options when needed.
- Prevent cross-contact and identify the responsible food-service contact.
- Offer nonalcoholic beverages with equal visibility and availability.

6.6 Hospitality and Guest Flow

Area	Planning questions
Arrival	Is the entrance obvious and staffed?
Registration	Can attendees check in without blocking circulation?
Seating	Are there varied seating types and accessible spaces?
Food service	Do buffet and beverage lines maintain clear routes?
Social space	Can guests converse without obstructing service or exits?
Information	Are restrooms, schedules, accessibility, and parking clearly communicated?

6.7 Alcohol Service

Alcohol may not be served until the event has received all required University, venue, and state approvals. University authorization, venue permission, event licensing, server credentials, insurance, security, and age-control procedures are separate considerations.

Use the [SOU Service Center forms page](#) to locate the current request to serve wine and beer on university grounds. Additionally it is recommended to review current [Oregon Liquor and Cannabis Commission alcohol-service requirements](#).

- Alcohol must be served only by people holding credentials required by Oregon law and the approved plan.
- Servers must follow current identification-verification and responsible-service requirements.
- The approved plan may require wristbands or another eligibility-control method.
- Provide visible nonalcoholic alternatives and food when appropriate.
- Define service opening, last call, closing, and refusal-of-service procedures.
- Confirm security, transportation, and insurance requirements.

7: Vendors, Contracts, Insurance, and External Services

7.1 Vendor Workflow

- Confirm that the service and vendor are permitted.
- Obtain venue- or activity-specific approval.
- Route any agreement through the University contracting process.
- Confirm insurance requirements.
- Complete vendor setup when University payment is required.
- Confirm access, utilities, parking, setup, operation, and removal.
- Document responsibilities and event-day contacts.

7.2 Vendor Approval and Payment Setup

Vendor approval and vendor payment setup are separate. A W-9 or Vendor Setup Form does not authorize a service, approve a contract, or confirm venue access.

Use the [SOU Service Center forms page](#) for current contract and vendor documents.

7.3 Insurance

Outside vendors and facility users may be required to provide proof of insurance at limits determined by the University and venue. Requirements may vary according to service, alcohol, attendance, activity, and risk. Confirm current requirements before executing an agreement.

7.4 External Production and Rental Services

- Audio, lighting, staging, livestreaming, and recording
- Furniture, tents, linens, décor, and barriers
- Registration systems, badge printing, and scanning
- Photography, videography, entertainment, and speakers
- Transportation and shuttle services
- Temporary power, internet, sanitation, and weather protection

7.5 Vendor Planning Worksheet

Vendor	Service	Contract	Insurance	Payment setup	Arrival	Utilities	Lead contact

8: Event Operations, Staffing, Load-In, and Load-Out

8.1 Event-Day Command Structure

Function	Primary responsibility
Event manager	Overall authority, schedule, decisions, and coordination
Venue representative	Room access, house rules, building systems
Technical lead	Sound, video, lighting, recording, troubleshooting
Accessibility lead	Accommodation delivery and route monitoring
Safety and security lead	Incident communication, crowd management, emergency coordination
Vendor and load-in lead	Vendor arrival, setup, storage, and removal
Registration lead	Check-in, information, attendance tracking
Hospitality lead	Food, beverage, green room, guest support

8.2 Staffing Plan

Staffing requirements depend on the venue, room, schedule, attendance, equipment, and event format. Performance venues may require house, stage, box-office, recording, or production personnel. Weekend and after-hours events may require additional coordination.

8.3 Load-In

- Confirm the approved access window and loading entrance.
- Assign vehicle, cart, elevator, hallway, and storage routes.
- Schedule setup in dependency order.
- Protect floors, walls, doors, elevators, and grounds.
- Keep exits, accessible routes, and emergency access clear.
- Remove empty packaging and cases from public areas.
- Complete testing and inspection before guests arrive.

8.4 Load-Out

- Release vendors in a controlled order.
- Inventory equipment and borrowed resources.
- Remove waste, signage, décor, and temporary attachments.
- Restore furniture and room condition.
- Document damage, missing equipment, or incidents.
- Confirm final pickup and building lock-up.

8.5 Preopening Inspection

- Exits, aisles, and accessible routes are clear.
- Capacity and seating match the approved plan.
- Microphones, playback, presentation, lighting, captions, and internet are tested.
- Cords, power distribution, stages, and temporary structures are secure.
- Registration, signage, restrooms, food, and accommodation locations are ready.
- Vendors have completed setup.

8.6 Run of Show

[illegible]

9: A/V, Technology, Recording, and Hybrid Events

9.1 Equipment Classifications

Classification	Definition
Included equipment	Installed or ordinarily included with the approved reservation
Available by request	University-owned equipment requiring separate scheduling, approval, or staffing
Externally rented equipment	Equipment supplied through an outside provider

9.2 Technical Planning Questions

- What must every attendee be able to hear or see?
- Which systems are installed in the room?
- Who is authorized and trained to operate them?
- What adapters, logins, permissions, or files are required?
- What internet capacity does the event need?
- What is the backup plan for each critical system?
- Are captions, interpreters, assistive listening, or accessible materials required?

9.3 Technical Walkthrough

Test	Confirm
Presentation	Computer, adapters, resolution, file playback, backup copy
Sound	Microphones, playback, audience questions, room coverage
Lighting	Stage, audience, recording, accessibility, emergency lighting
Internet	Login, bandwidth, guest access, vendor devices
Recording	Permissions, framing, audio, storage, captions, delivery
Hybrid	Remote moderation, return audio, chat, captions, backup connection

9.4 Internet and Hybrid Events

Reliable internet is critical when your event relies on streaming, cloud-based presentations, remote attendees, or connected vendors such as DJs and registration systems. Always test the network under realistic conditions and consider a dedicated connection if your data needs exceed standard guest Wi-Fi.

9.5 Recording and Livestreaming

- Confirm venue capability and required production staff.
- Obtain speaker, performer, music, and audience permissions as applicable.
- Plan captions and accessible distribution.
- Identify who owns, stores, edits, and publishes the recording.
- Confirm delivery format and timeline.

9.6 Campus Collaboration

Event organizers are encouraged to explore consultation and collaboration with students, faculty, staff, academic programs, and campus production resources. Potential collaborators include the [Digital Media Center](#), [Digital Cinema](#), [Emerging Media and Digital Arts](#), [Communication](#), [Theatre](#), [Music](#), and other relevant programs. Establish scope, supervision, schedule, compensation, and any academic relationship directly with participants.

10: Accessibility and Inclusive Event Design

10.1 Accessibility Is Event-Wide

Accessibility must be integrated into venue selection, registration, communication, layout, technology, food service, and emergency planning. A ramp, elevator, or accessible entrance does not guarantee full event accessibility.

10.2 Complete Attendee Journey

Stage	Confirm
Before arrival	Accessible registration, accommodation contact, parking and route information
Arrival	Accessible parking, drop-off, entrance, signs, check-in
Participation	Seating, stage access, interpreters, captions, microphones, materials
Hospitality	Food labels, dietary access, clear service routes, quiet alternatives
Emergency	Visible and audible communication, evacuation or shelter, accountability
After event	Accessible recordings, captions, transcripts, documents

10.3 Accommodation Requests

Event announcements and registration materials must explain how attendees may request disability accommodations. [Contact SOU Disability Resources](#) or the sponsoring office to confirm appropriate wording and the request process.

10.4 Communication Access

- American Sign Language interpretation
- Communication Access Realtime Translation
- Captions and transcripts
- Microphones for presenters and audience questions
- Accessible presentation materials
- Audio description when visual information is essential
- Plain-language instructions and descriptive hyperlinks

10.5 Physical Access

- Accessible parking, drop-off, entrance, and route
- Doorways, aisles, elevators, ramps, and thresholds
- Integrated accessible seating and companion seating
- Accessible stage or presentation area
- Accessible restrooms and service counters
- Clear routes through registration, food, exhibits, and social areas
- Accessible emergency egress and assistance planning

10.6 Digital Access

- Use selectable text rather than images of text.
- Use real heading styles and logical reading order.
- Provide alt text for meaningful images.
- Caption video and transcribe audio.
- Use accessible color contrast.
- Use descriptive, directly linked text rather than bare URLs.
- Export tagged, searchable PDF files.

10.7 Sensory and Social Access

- Warn attendees about loud sound, bright light, flashing effects, smoke, or other sensory conditions.
- Provide a quieter option when practical.
- Offer varied seating.
- Use name tags and communication practices that respect individual preferences.
- Avoid unnecessary sensory barriers.

Review the [SOU campus map](#) and [contact Disability Resources](#) when confirming the complete event route.

11: Risk Management, Safety, and Emergency Planning

11.1 Risk Assessment

Element	Question
Hazard	What could cause injury, damage, disruption, or noncompliance?
Likelihood	How likely is the hazard under the planned conditions?
Consequence	What could happen if the hazard occurs?
Control	What will eliminate or reduce the risk?
Responsible role	Who implements and monitors the control?
Trigger	What change requires escalation, cancellation, or a new plan?

11.2 Common Risk Categories

- Crowd movement and capacity
- Weather, wildfire smoke, and outdoor exposure
- Medical needs and emergency access
- Fire, electrical distribution, and temporary structures
- Food safety and alcohol service
- Transportation and parking
- Vendors, contracts, and insurance
- Technology and communications failure
- Security, protest, cash, and public figures
- Accessibility and accommodation failure

11.3 Campus Public Safety Coordination

Campus Public Safety must be contacted and alerted of any on-campus events. Coordination is particularly important for large public attendance, outside visitors, alcohol, after-hours activity, demonstrations, candidate or dignitary visits, cash handling, or elevated risk.

Need	Contact
Active police, fire, or medical emergency	911
Campus officer assistance, including after hours	541-552-6911
Campus Public Safety administrative office	541-552-6258
Administrative email	campuspublicsafety@sou.edu
Parking Services	541-552-PARK

11.4 Campus Emergency Protocols

Event planners should review current [campus emergency protocols](#) while developing safety and response plans. Planning should account for emergency communication, evacuation or shelter procedures, attendee accountability, responder access, and staff responsibilities.

11.5 Emergency Plan Components

- Emergency contacts and decision authority
- Communication to staff and attendees
- Evacuation, shelter, and accountability
- Medical response and responder access
- Accessible emergency communication
- Weather and cancellation thresholds
- Incident documentation and follow-up

11.6 Incident Report

Field	Record
Date, time, location	
People involved	
What occurred	
Immediate action	
Notifications	
Injury or damage	
Follow-up required	

12: Sustainability, Waste Reduction, and Shared Resources

12.1 Reduce Before Disposal

1. Reduce unnecessary materials and purchases.
2. Reuse appropriate venue and campus resources.
3. Select lower-waste products and service formats.
4. Sort remaining materials according to current University guidance.

12.2 Materials and Purchasing

- Limit unnecessary décor, packaging, and single-use items.
- Estimate attendance carefully.
- Use digital materials when they remain accessible.
- Select reusable or recyclable items only when the appropriate collection pathway exists.
- Plan who will remove, wash, return, or store reusable resources.

12.3 Waste Stations

Plan the number, placement, labels, and monitoring of landfill, recycling, and any available compost stations. Review [Sustainability at SOU](#) and current [SOU recycling guidance](#) before creating signs. [Contact Sustainability at SOU](#) with event-specific questions.

12.4 Shared Campus Resources

Before renting equipment, ask the venue and sponsoring department whether appropriate tables, chairs, signs, service items, waste stations, décor, plants, or other shared resources are available. Confirm ownership, permission, transport, setup, return, and damage responsibility.

12.5 Reusable Service Ware

Ask the catering provider or venue whether reusable service ware, linens, and beverage equipment are available. Confirm quantities, labor, washing, transport, and return. Availability is not guaranteed.

12.6 Cleanup and Restoration

- Remove waste, signage, décor, packaging, and temporary materials.
- Sort materials according to current guidance.
- Return borrowed resources to the correct owner.
- Restore the venue and document damage.
- Complete a final walkthrough with the responsible venue representative.

13: Marketing, Promotion, and Campus Communications

13.1 Build the Marketing Plan

Element	Decision
Audience	Who should attend?
Objective	Awareness, registration, attendance, participation, or fundraising?
Message	What is the event, why does it matter, and what should the reader do?
Channel	Where can the intended audience be reached?
Schedule	When should each message be published?
Access	How will accommodations, parking, and registration be communicated?
Measurement	How will reach, registration, attendance, and engagement be evaluated?

13.2 Event Listing and Registration

Use [Hawk N.E.S.T.](#) for supported student-organization event functions. Submit eligible public events through the [SOU Events Calendar](#).

13.3 Printed Materials

[SOU Print and Copy Services](#) provides institutional printing, copying, scanning, design support, posters, and large-format work. Request a current quote and production schedule before setting the promotional deadline.

- Obtain content, brand, and building-posting approval as required.
- Use accessible text, contrast, hierarchy, and descriptive links.
- Include registration, parking, and accommodation information.
- Remove materials after the approved posting period.

13.4 Campus Channels

Channel	Use	Confirmation
Hawk N.E.S.T.	Student-organization listing, registration, communication	Confirm current functions
SOU Events Calendar	Eligible public event listing	Use current submission process
Stevenson Union posting	Student-facing flyers and posters	Follow current Student Life posting requirements
University Housing	Residence-hall audiences	Contact Housing before distribution
Department channels	Targeted academic or staff audiences	Obtain department approval
Digital signage	Brief visual promotion	Confirm owner, format, and lead time
Inside SOU and email lists	Internal audiences	Do not assume access; confirm eligibility

Contact [University Housing](#) before planning distribution through residence-hall channels.

13.5 Promotional Accessibility

- Refer to the [SOU Accessibility Training document](#) for social media posting best practices
- Use selectable text and real headings.
- Avoid flyers that communicate essential information only through an image.
- Use readable contrast and font sizes.
- Include directly linked registration and accommodation calls to action.
- Provide text alternatives for images and captions for video

14: Campus Resource and Contact Directory

Function	Resource	Contact or link
Student clubs and event approval	Office of Student Belonging and Engagement	studentlife.sou.edu/clubs/
Student engagement platform	Hawk N.E.S.T.	hawknest.sou.edu
Forms	SOU Service Center	sc.sou.edu/forms/
Purchasing and contracts	SOU Purchasing and Contracting	purchasing@sou.edu
Accessibility	SOU Disability Resources	dr@sou.edu
Public Safety administration	Campus Public Safety	campuspublicsafety@sou.edu
Public Safety officer assistance	Campus Public Safety	541-552-6911
Parking	SOU Parking Services	parking@sou.edu
Stevenson Union	Scheduling	su_scheduling@sou.edu
OCA administration	Oregon Center for the Arts	oca@sou.edu
OCA ticketing	OCA Box Office	boxoffice@sou.edu
Hannon Library	Room scheduling	libraryevents@sou.edu
Sustainability	Sustainability at SOU	sustainability@sou.edu
The Farm	The Farm at SOU	thefarm@sou.edu
Printing	Print and Copy Services	printcopy.sou.edu
Campus map	SOU interactive map	sou.edu/map/

15: Planning Timelines and Checklists

15.1 Three to Four Months or More

- Define goals, audience, format, and attendance.
- Identify sponsor and budget.
- Begin venue inquiry and major approvals.
- Identify production, vendor, accessibility, and security needs.
- Develop marketing and registration strategy.

15.2 Six to Eight Weeks

- Confirm venue and initial layout.
- Contact catering and service providers.
- Begin outside-food, vendor, contract, and insurance processes.
- Confirm staffing and equipment categories.
- Develop risk and accessibility plans.
- Begin design and promotion.

15.3 One Month

- Finalize major services and vendors.
- Confirm parking and arrival plan.
- Launch registration and marketing.
- Draft run of show and staff plan.
- Confirm accommodation request process.

15.4 Two Weeks

- Confirm attendance and catering count.
- Complete technical walkthrough.
- Confirm vendors, staffing, signage, and load-in.
- Review emergency protocols and risk controls.
- Send attendee arrival information.

15.5 Event Week

- Finalize presentation and media files.
- Confirm weather, closures, and access.
- Brief staff and volunteers.
- Confirm vendor arrival and contact list.
- Prepare registration, signage, accessibility, and incident materials.

15.6 Event Day

- Inspect and secure the site.
- Complete setup and technical testing.
- Brief staff and confirm command structure.
- Monitor routes, sound, access, service, and schedule.
- Document incidents and changes.
- Control load-out and final inspection.

15.7 Post-Event

- Return equipment and shared resources.
- Complete vendor and financial closeout.
- Submit incident or damage reports.
- Debrief staff and partners.
- Evaluate outcomes and document lessons learned.

16: Templates and Planning Tools

These templates support planning but do not replace official University forms.

16.1 Event Concept Worksheet

Prompt	Response
Event title	
Purpose and desired outcome	
Sponsor	
Audience	
Estimated attendance	
Preferred date and alternatives	
Event format	
Budget source	
Critical services	
Primary decision maker	

16.2 Venue Comparison Worksheet

Criterion	Venue A	Venue B	Venue C
Capacity and setup			
Accessibility			
Included equipment			
Staffing			
Food and beverage			
Load-in			
Parking			
Schedule			
Cost categories			

16.3 Approval Tracker

[illegible]

16.4 Accessibility Checklist

Area	Confirmed	Responsible Party	Notes
Registration and accommodation request			
Accessible parking and arrival			
Entrance and route			
Seating and stage access			
Restrooms			
Communication access			
Food and dietary access			
Emergency communication and egress			
Accessible post-event materials			

16.5 Risk Assessment

Hazard	Likelihood	Consequence	Control	Responsible role	Trigger

16.6 A/V and Technology Checklist

System	Required	Included	Requested or rented	Operator	Test result
Presentation display					
Microphones					
Playback					
Lighting					
Internet					
Recording					
Livestreaming					
Captions or access					

16.7 Post-Event Evaluation

Area	Result	Evidence	Improvement
Objectives			
Attendance			
Guest experience			
Accessibility			
Operations			
Budget			
Vendors			
Safety and incidents			
Marketing			
Sustainability			

17: Guide Adoption and Maintenance Recommendations

17.1 Status of the Guide

This is a student-produced institutional resource compiled and edited by the BA 510 graduate students from research completed the University's BA 410/510 *Event Management* course. Publication or long-term institutional maintenance is not guaranteed by completion of the course project.

17.2 Recommended Ownership

If adopted for continuing use, the University should designate a responsible office or cross-functional group to review and maintain the guide.

17.3 Recommended Annual Review

- Contacts and office names
- Forms and platforms
- Deadlines and approval pathways
- Venue capacities, layouts, and equipment
- Policy and regulatory links
- Brand standards and accessibility
- Broken links and outdated screenshots
- Version and current-as-of dates

17.4 Recommended Distribution

- Student Life and Hawk N.E.S.T.
- University Housing and departmental resource pages
- Venue and conference pages
- Inside SOU and internal communications, subject to approval
- Downloadable accessible PDF and editable source file

Appendix A: Current Institutional Resources

Resource	Direct link	Primary use
Clubs and Organizations	Clubs and Organizations	Student-organization guidance and FAQs
Hawk N.E.S.T.	Hawk N.E.S.T.	Student engagement and supported event functions
SOU Service Center Forms	SOU Service Center Forms	Current contracting, vendor, food, alcohol, and administrative forms
Finance and Administration	Finance and Administration	Purchasing, contracting, budget, and Service Center routing
Disability Resources	Disability Resources	Accommodation and accessibility support
Campus Public Safety	Campus Public Safety	Emergency, officer-assistance, and administrative contacts
University Emergency Resource Guide	University Emergency Resource Guide	Current campus emergency protocols
Parking Services	Parking Services	Current parking information
Stevenson Union Event Spaces	Stevenson Union Event Spaces	Current room and scheduling information
Oregon Center for the Arts	Oregon Center for the Arts	Arts administration, venues, and programs
Student Recreation Center Rentals	Student Recreation Center Rentals	Current recreation-space rental process
SOU Campus Map	SOU Campus Map	Buildings, parking, routes, and wayfinding
Sustainability at SOU	Sustainability at SOU	Current sustainability and waste resources
The Farm at SOU	The Farm at SOU	Farm programs and partnerships
Print and Copy Services	Print and Copy Services	Institutional printing and production
SOU Events Calendar	SOU Events Calendar	Public event listings

Appendix B: Contact Directory

Function	Contact
Club guidance	SOU Clubs and Organizations webpage
Purchasing and Contracting	purchasing@sou.edu
Disability Resources	dr@sou.edu
Campus Public Safety	campuspublicsafety@sou.edu
Parking Services	parking@sou.edu
Stevenson Union Scheduling	su_scheduling@sou.edu
Oregon Center for the Arts	oca@sou.edu
OCA Box Office	boxoffice@sou.edu
Hannon Library scheduling	libraryevents@sou.edu
Sustainability	sustainability@sou.edu
The Farm	thefarm@sou.edu
University Housing	housing@sou.edu

Appendix C Policy and Form Documents

[Assumption of Risk form](#)

[SOU Resource Handling Policy acknowledgment](#)

[Purchasing Card Activity log](#)

[Event Parking Request Form](#)

[Conditions of Volunteer Service Form](#)

[Vendor Setup Form](#)

[Request to Serve Wine and Beer on SOU Grounds](#)

[Official SOU Emergency Procedures](#)

[Report of Gift Received by Department](#)

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